Unit 2 — School Life Elsewhere

Track G+M · Klasse 8 · Niveau G/M

Learning objectives I

- *I can read short pen-pal texts from 3 countries and compare them.*
- *I can use the present passive to talk about how things are done elsewhere.*
- *I can hold a 2-minute conversation comparing schools.*

Lead-in I

Mr. Ade pinned three printed e-mails to the noticeboard. One from a school in Lagos. One from a school in Helsinki. One from a school in São Paulo. Three students were assigned to read them and report back. Hawa read all three twice before lunch.

Reading I

Reading — three short pen-pal extracts
Lagos. In our school, lessons are taught in English, but we speak Yoruba and Igbo with friends. Uniform is compulsory. Lunch is brought from home.
Helsinki. In Finland, school starts at age 7. Homework is given lightly. Lunch is provided free. We go outside for a break every hour, even in -10°C.
São Paulo. Our school day is split: lessons in the morning, sports in the afternoon. Homework is set every day. Lunch is bought at a small canteen.

Grammar — present passive
Form: *to be* (in tense) + past participle.

Reading II

- *Lessons are taught in English.*
- *Homework is given lightly.*
- *Lunch is provided free.*
- *Sports are played in the afternoon.*

Use the passive when *who* does the action is obvious or unimportant.

Practise I

Niveau G

1. Active → passive: They teach lessons in English. → ___ ; The school provides lunch. → ___ ; Teachers give homework. → ___ .
2. Choose active or passive (more natural): *(somebody / set / homework / every day)* → ___ .

Niveau M

3. Build 4 sentences in present passive about how things are done at your school.

Your turn I

Pair speaking — *Compare three schools*. 2 min each. Use 3 passive structures + one comparison. Report back to the class with one *I learned that …* sentence.

Sample
— In Helsinki, lunch is provided free at school, while in São Paulo lunch is bought at a canteen. — Yes, and homework is given more in São Paulo than in Helsinki.

Reflect I

- I can read three pen-pal texts and compare them.
- I can build present passive sentences.
- I can run a 2-minute compare-and-contrast conversation.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC News — *Education* short articles.
- British Council Schools Online — pen-pal projects.